

Mosaics were mainly used on floors, but some walls were also decorated with mosaic pictures. Like paintings, there was a range of mosaic styles to suit a person's taste and budget. The cheapest mosaics were simple

Glassware and pottery

The Romans were also skilled glassworkers. Flasks and bottles were mass-produced by blowing glass into molds. Fine glassware might have bands of gold running through it.

ONE HOUSE IN POMPEII HAD A “BEWARE OF THE DOG” MOSAIC.

geometric patterns—squares, triangles, or diamonds—often made from large, roughly shaped cubes or even pebbles. These patterns could be repeated over and over again until the whole floor was covered.

More costly mosaics used tiny cubes to make highly detailed, lifelike images of people, gods, and animals.

Cubes of pure gold, rock crystal, and rare marble were used in the most luxurious mosaics, giving them a stunning, jewel-like quality.

Potters were kept busy making all manner of ceramic vessels, from clay lamps, bowls, and cups to large storage vessels (*amphorae*) used to hold wine and oil.

Pottery was often decorated with molded pictures or,

sometimes, given a glaze, which gave its surface a shiny, glasslike look.

Many of the images on pots and in mosaics and paintings were of gods, goddesses, and scenes from the Roman religion, which was at the heart of Roman life.



THIS BEAUTIFUL ROMAN VASE WAS MADE FROM COLORED GLASS.